

How to handle pitches without burning out

One independent host's two mailboxes, 2022 to October 2026: 639 pitch-like threads from 458 senders. Volume tripled, and his explicit declines grew from 7% of pitches in 2023 to 53% in 2026.

Pitch threads per year, both mailboxes

Explicit declines were 7% of pitch threads in 2023, 13% in 2024, 28% in 2025 and 53% in 2026. Silence fell from about one in three to one in ten.



1 Write the rule before the volume

This host asked for a pivotal moment from 2022 and was declining pitches that did not fit by 2023. A written rule makes the no easy to send.

3 Say your rule where pitchers read it

A pitch page that names the one moment, the current focus and what the show is not should screen pitches before they arrive.

5 Judge the story, not the sender

Publicists and experts send a large share of pitches. The same test applies to them as to anyone.

7 Tag every pitch by outcome

Advanced, asked, declined, silent. Labeled mail is how this host could see his own drift, and steer it on purpose.

2 Keep three replies ready

Not the right fit. Fully booked. Tell me the specific moment. Each is a few lines long.

4 Ask once

If a pitch hints at a story, one clear question about the moment is enough. Do not workshop an angle with a sender who sent a topic list.

6 Say what silence means

About one pitch thread in three got no reply through 2025. If you will not answer every pitch, tell senders so.

8 Plan for being one person

The host runs the show alone. A short template keeps a late no kind, and a written rule keeps it quick.

2022, AN OPEN INVITATION

"I'd love to talk more about one of the most pivotal moments in your life, if you'd like to share."

2026, A CLEAR RULE

"The show is built around one deeply personal moment where everything changed for the guest."